

# FILM DOSSIER: IRON MAN 3

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Phase 2 · Film #1 (Saga Film #9)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                     |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 9 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #1)                                                |
| Phase                  | Phase 2 (2013–2015)                                                       |
| Real title             | <i>IRON MAN 3</i>                                                         |
| Decoy / codename title | " <i>HIBERNATION</i> "                                                    |
| Release date           | Friday, May 3, 2013                                                       |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                       |
| Director               | Shane Black                                                               |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 162 minutes                                                       |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>biotech techno-thriller / body horror</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                           |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK</b> (Iron Man, film 3 of the franchise) |

| Character                                                   | Actor                                                                   | Age at release                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Tony Stark / Iron Man                                       | Marc-Anthony Bullock                                                    | 31                                        |
| Pepper Potts                                                | Tayia Boyd                                                              | 31                                        |
| James Rhodes / War Machine                                  | Don Cheadle                                                             | 48                                        |
| The Mandarin                                                | Tony Leung                                                              | 50                                        |
| Dr. Maya Hansen                                             | Rebecca Hall                                                            | 31 ( <i>her birthday is release day</i> ) |
| Aldrich Killian                                             | Guy Pearce                                                              | 45                                        |
| Mallen                                                      | James Badge Dale ( <i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i> ) | 35                                        |
| Happy Hogan                                                 | Jon Favreau                                                             | 46                                        |
| Bruce Banner ( <i>mid-credit cameo</i> )                    | Amond Baker                                                             | 31                                        |
| Agent Jasper Sitwell                                        | Maximiliano Hernández                                                   | 39                                        |
| Mistress Death ( <i>at Tony's cocoon</i> )                  | Aubrey Plaza                                                            | 28                                        |
| Stan Lee ( <i>cameo: a beauty-pageant judge in Austin</i> ) | Stan Lee                                                                | 90                                        |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <b><i>Iron Man: Extremis</i></b> , <i>Iron Man</i> vol. 4 #1–6 (2005–06), Warren Ellis & Adi Granov: Maya Hansen, Aldrich Killian, <b>Mallen</b> , and <b>Tony injecting himself with Extremis</b> . " <b><i>Haunted</i></b> ", <i>Iron Man: Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.</i> #29–32 (2008), Stuart Moore & Carlos Pacheco: <b>the Mandarin forces Maya Hansen to perfect Extremis</b> for a worldwide release. |
| Supporting comics        | <b><i>Iron Man</i> #281–284</b> (1992): Tony builds the " <b>Variable Threat Response Battle Suit</b> ," and <b>Rhodey takes it as War Machine</b> · <b><i>Iron Man</i> vol. 5 #23–28</b> (2014), Kieron Gillen: after the Mandarin's defeat, <b>the ten rings leave to seek new bearers</b>                                                                                                                |
| Nerf check               | ✓ Mallen <b>beats Iron Man badly</b> in their first fight, exactly as in <i>Extremis</i> #3. Tony wins the rematch because Extremis makes him <b>stronger than ever</b> , not because Mallen got weaker.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | 96%. <i>Extremis</i> is adapted almost beat for beat, joined to the Mandarin's Extremis scheme from "Haunted" (2008). |

#### Straight from the page:

- **Extremis** is a nanotech **super-soldier virus** from **Futurepharm** in **Austin, Texas**. It rewrites the body's "repair center" and needs a **cocoon stage** (*Extremis* #1).
- **Aldrich Killian** leaks Extremis and **takes his own life** (#1). This happens off-screen for PG-13.
- **Mallen**, a domestic extremist, is injected with it and gains **super strength, regeneration, and fire breath**. He massacres an FBI convoy in **Houston** (#1–2).
- **Mallen beats Iron Man badly** (#3).
- **Tony, near death, has Maya Hansen inject him with Extremis**. He goes into a **cocoon**. He comes out able to **store the armor's undersheath inside his hollow bones, control the armor with his mind, and connect directly to every network and satellite on Earth** (#4–5).
- **The Mandarin coerces Maya into perfecting Extremis** so he can release it worldwide ("Haunted").
- **Tony builds the War Machine armor and Rhodey takes it** (*Iron Man* #281–284).
- **When the Mandarin falls, the rings leave to seek new hosts** (vol. 5 #28).

#### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Mandarin's Extremis plot (2008) is combined with *Extremis* (2005) | It gives the Iron Man trilogy one villain throughout. The Mandarin carries through all three films. |

| War Machine (1992) arrives in the Extremis-era film | Rhodey has earned his own armor since "Next time, baby" in 2008. |

| Maya Hansen's fate | She survives the film. Her 616 death (2008) is held back, and **she's arrested for her part in the Extremis program**. |

#### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                                   | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                       | Shown in this film                                                                                                                                  | Held back (why)                                                  | Match                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tony Stark (Extremis)</b>                | <b>The undersheath stored in his bones; mental control of the armor; direct wireless connection to phones, networks and satellites;</b> boosted healing and reflexes ( <i>Extremis</i> #4–5) | All of it. He calls the armor by thought, reads a city's CCTV grid in a second, takes over a missile's guidance, and his wounds close within hours. | Later Bleeding Edge / nanotech armor (616, 2008–09, later films) | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>Iron Man (Model 29 / Extremis armor)</b> | A thinner, stronger, faster armor, run through Extremis                                                                                                                                      | Supersonic flight, repulsors, uni-beam, catching a falling 747 fuselage                                                                             | –                                                                | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>War Machine</b>                          | Heavily armed Iron Man variant: <b>shoulder-mounted cannon, missiles, flamethrowers, gauntlet guns</b> ( <i>Iron Man</i> #281)                                                               | All of it; he holds a bridge against thirty Extremis soldiers                                                                                       | –                                                                | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>Mallen</b>                               | <b>Extremis super strength, near-instant regeneration, fire breath, electrical projection</b> ( <i>Extremis</i> #1–5)                                                                        | All of it. Round one, he nearly kills Iron Man.                                                                                                     | –                                                                | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>The Mandarin</b>                         | All ten Makluan rings; master martial artist; genius                                                                                                                                         | All ten rings again, plus a Makluan-built <b>ring-powered battle armor</b> in the finale                                                            | –                                                                | ✓ 100%. He loses to <b>Extremis-boosted Tony plus War Machine.</b> |
| <b>Extremis soldiers</b>                    | Super strength, regeneration, heat projection; <b>unstable</b> (they can explode)                                                                                                            | The Mandarin's army                                                                                                                                 | –                                                                | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>Maya Hansen</b>                          | Genius biochemist ( <i>Extremis</i> #1)                                                                                                                                                      | Designs Extremis; saves Tony's life                                                                                                                 | –                                                                | ✓ 100%                                                             |
| <b>Pepper Potts</b>                         | Executive; courageous                                                                                                                                                                        | Runs Stark Industries through the crisis and hides Maya's data                                                                                      | <b>Rescue</b> armor (616, 2009, later films)                     | ✓ 100%                                                             |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | After saving the world, Tony Stark can't stop building armor. Then a virus that makes men into weapons shows up, and it's connected to the Mandarin, and Tony has to put the armor inside himself to survive. |
| Theme                | <b>The armor was always inside him.</b> Iron Man isn't the suit. It's the man.                                                                                                                                |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>The Mandarin</b> (main); <b>Mallen</b> (his Extremis enforcer); <b>Aldrich Killian</b> (the leak that starts it)                                                                                           |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE LEAK

- **Monday, January 7, 2013.** Eight months after *The Avengers*, Tony is paying for the team, running Stark Industries, and not sleeping. He's building armor after armor in the Avengers Mansion basement. He's **stayed sober**, and Pepper sees the building for what it is: a new bottle.
- In **Austin, Texas**, **Dr. Maya Hansen**, an old acquaintance of Tony's, calls in a panic. Her partner **Aldrich Killian** has **leaked Extremis** and **taken his own life**.
- **Houston**: a man named **Mallen**, injected with Extremis, **wipes out an FBI convoy** with fire and bare hands.

#### ACT TWO: THE COCOON

- Iron Man goes after Mallen, and Mallen **almost kills him**. The armor is shredded, Tony's organs are failing, and Rhodey drags him out.
- Maya offers the one thing that could save him: **Extremis**.
- Tony agrees. He goes into the **cocoon**.
- In the dark, his heart stops. Only the audience sees **the hooded woman** standing at the foot of the bed. **She looks at Tony, then turns away**. He wakes.
- **Tony comes out of the cocoon changed**. He can think the armor onto his body and hear every phone in Texas. In the **rematch** in downtown Houston, he takes Mallen apart.
- Maya's funding trail leads to **the Mandarin**. He forced her to make Extremis stable for **mass release**.

#### ACT THREE: WAR MACHINE

- The Mandarin plans to spread an aerosol form of Extremis from his Makluan starship over **Beijing, Mumbai, Lagos and New York**, and whoever survives will be his army.
- Tony gives Rhodey the **Variable Threat Response Battle Suit**. Rhodey: *"Took you long enough."* **War Machine** is born.
- **The Valley of Spirits**. Tony, in the Extremis armor, and War Machine fight through the Mandarin's Extremis soldiers.
- **Iron Man vs. the Mandarin** in his ring-powered armor. All ten rings against a man who runs his armor by thought. Tony uses **Extremis to overload the starship's reactor through the Mandarin's own link to it**.
- The Mandarin falls into the reactor core. **His body is never found**.

- Maya is arrested. At Avengers Mansion, Tony stands in the basement full of armors, then shuts the lights off and goes upstairs to Pepper.
- Final line, voiceover: *"They can take the suits. They can't take the armor. I am Iron Man."*

## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, January 7, 2013 → Saturday, April 6, 2013.</b> The mid-credit and post-credit scenes are in <b>April 2013</b> .                                                     |
| Where it's set          | <b>Avengers Mansion, NYC · Futurepharm, Austin, Texas · Houston · Stark Industries, Long Island · the Valley of Spirits, China</b> (filmed in Texas and in Zhangjiajie, Hunan) |
| Relative to other films | <b>Eight months after <i>The Avengers</i>.</b> Tony mentions that "Cap's out running the team this month," and that "Big Green hasn't called."                                 |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Extremis:** Tony is permanently changed and fused with his technology.
- **War Machine:** Rhodey's own armor.
- **The end of the Mandarin trilogy (2008–2013),** and the rings loose in the world.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                                       | How it appears                                                                                                         | Payoff                     |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>The Avengers are an institution now</b> | The Mansion, Jarvis running a staff, a monitor duty rotation board:<br><i>CAP · THOR · WASP · GIANT-MAN · IRON MAN</i> | <i>Avengers 2</i>          |
| <b>Extremis in the world</b>               | Doses are missing from Futurepharm's inventory                                                                         | Phase 2–3                  |
| <b>The Hulk</b>                            | The mid-credit scene                                                                                                   | The Hulk's<br>Phase 2 film |
| <b>The Cosmic Cube</b>                     | Sitwell's briefing: A.I.M. is buying Futurepharm's Extremis stock <i>"to stabilize something they lost"</i>            | Phase 2                    |

## Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                       | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | What it means                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Death turns away from Tony | The cocoon flatline                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Tony has now seen Death twice (Yinsen and himself). <b>She keeps passing him by.</b>                                      |
| The Elders of the Universe | In the Mandarin's starship, the Makluan star-charts glow: <b>six points of light, each beside a different figure.</b> The Mandarin says, <i>"The jewels are held by the Elders of the Universe... and the Titan has begun to take them."</i> | <b>The Thanos Quest has started.</b> On 616, Thanos takes the Gems from the Elders ( <i>The Thanos Quest</i> #1–2, 1990). |
| The rings                  | The post-credit scene                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | The rings go looking for new bearers.                                                                                     |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       |  <b>"THERAPY."</b> Avengers Mansion. Tony has spent the whole night telling <b>Bruce Banner</b> about Extremis, the cocoon, the Mandarin, all of it. He finally turns around. <b>Bruce is asleep</b> in the armchair.<br><b>TONY:</b> <i>"...Seriously?"</i><br><b>BRUCE</b> (waking): <i>"I'm a nuclear physicist, Tony. I'm not that kind of doctor."</i><br>(beat)<br><b>BRUCE:</b> <i>"Also, I've been awake for four days. The other guy doesn't sleep."</i> |
| Post-credit scene      |  <b>"TEN."</b> The ruins of the Makluan starship in the Valley of Spirits, at night. In the rubble of the reactor core, <b>the Mandarin's ten rings lie in the ash.</b> One by one they <b>glow, rise, and fly off</b> in ten directions across the world. <b>The last one heads straight up, toward the stars. CUT TO BLACK. "IRON MAN WILL RETURN."</b>                                                                                                        |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: <b>"NAP TIME."</b> Post-credit: <b>"JEWELRY BOX II."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline